



Pool and Bracket Formats

TGT 2 Pools and Bracket Format



Pool play starts	8:45 AM
Bracket play starts	1:00 PM (Possibly 12:15 PM Day 2)
All teams advance to playoffs	Regardless of pool record
⚠️ Single elimination	Single elim for all divisions; all play for 3rd/4th

Pool Play Format

Every team is guaranteed to play multiple opponents in pool play before bracket play. Pool size depends on division registration. Match scoring scales with pool size to keep the total points played per team roughly equal across divisions.

Seeding & Pool Placement

Initial seeding is based on TruVolley rankings. Tournament directors may adjust any seeding based on known team strength when needed.

Teams	Pool Structure	Match Format	Minimum Pts Per Team
4	Round robin (1 group of 4)	2 sets to 21 vs each opponent	126
5	Round robin (1 group of 5)	2 sets to 15 vs each opponent	120
6	Round robin (1 group of 6)	2 sets to 12 vs each opponent	120
7	Round robin (1 group of 7)	2 sets to 12 vs each opponent	144
8	2 pools of 4	2 sets to 21 vs each opponent	126
9	1 pool of 4 + 1 pool of 5	2 sets to 21 (pool of 4) / 2 sets to 15 (pool of 5)	126 or 120
10	2 pools of 5	2 sets to 15 vs each opponent	120
11	1 pool of 5 + 1 pool of 6	2 sets to 15 (pool of 5) / 2 sets to 12 (pool of 6)	120 or 120
12	3 pools of 4	2 sets to 21 vs each opponent	126
13	2 pools of 4 + 1 pool of 5	2 sets to 21 (pool of 4) / 2 sets to 15 (pool of 5)	126 or 120
14	1 pool of 4 + 2 pools of 5	2 sets to 21 (pool of 4) / 2 sets to 15 (pool of 5)	126 or 120
15	3 pools of 5	2 sets to 15 vs each opponent	120
16	4 pools of 4	2 sets to 21 vs each opponent	126

Why scoring shifts with pool size: Larger pools mean more matchups. We scale scoring (21 → 15 → 12) so total points played per team stays roughly equal. This is the fairest way to guarantee everyone plays multiple opponents without overworking teams in larger pools.

Disclaimer for pools of 6 or 7: Sets to 12 are short. Playing 2 sets per opponent gives more chances to bounce back from a rough set rather than playing 1 larger set.

Bracket Play Format

All Divisions

Every team advances to the playoff bracket regardless of pool record. Pool play determines seeding only.

⚠️ Single elimination: Bracket play is single elimination. One loss eliminates a team from championship contention — **the only exception is the 3rd/4th place game between the two semifinal losers.**

Match Format by Playoff Round

Round	Format
Divisions of 8 teams or fewer	All matches best of 3 (sets to 21, 21, 15) from the start of bracket play
Divisions of 9+ teams (rounds before top 8)	1 set to 30 - all necessary matches to advance to top 8 (ex: round of 16)
Round of 8 (quarterfinals) onward	Best of 3 (sets to 21, 21, 15)
Semifinals	Best of 3 (sets to 21, 21, 15)
Finals & 3rd/4th place game	Best of 3 (sets to 21, 21, 15)

9-team brackets: Seeds #8 and #9 play a play-in match (1 set to 30). Other round of top 8 bracket games may run concurrently with the play-in and will be played as best 2 out of 3 sets (21, 21, 15).

Small Division Bracket Structure (4-7 teams)

Small divisions play a round robin (pool play above), then a single-elimination playoff bracket based on round-robin seeding. All matches are best of 3 (21/21/15).

Teams	Playoff Structure
4	#1 vs #4, #2 vs #3 → winners play for championship, losers play for 3rd
5	#4 vs #5 play-in → winner plays #1; #2 vs #3 → winners to final, losers to 3rd-place game
6	#1 and #2 get byes to top 4. Play-ins: #4 vs #5 (plays #1), #3 vs #6 (plays #2). Then semis → final + 3rd place
7	#1 gets a bye. Round 1: #2 vs #7, #3 vs #6, #4 vs #5. Then quarters/semis → final + 3rd place

Youth Divisions — Combined Pools, Separate Brackets

- If youth registration numbers are low in any single age division, we may combine adjacent age divisions for pool play to ensure every team plays multiple opponents and gets the most out of their day.
- Once pool play concludes, teams return to their original age divisions for bracket play — so each age group (13U, 15U, 18U, etc.) will still crown its own champion based on bracket results.
- We'll combine for pool play if a division has fewer than 4 teams.

This format gives players more competitive reps in pool play while still preserving age-appropriate playoff competition.

Pool Play Tiebreakers

When teams are tied in pool record in sets won/lost, seeding is determined in this order:

Order	Tiebreaker
1	Head-to-head Record
2	Head-to-head Point Differential
3	Total Point Differential
4	Coin Flip

Volleyball Life has these tiebreaker systems built in and will automatically settle ties during seeding.

General Rules & Notes

- All matches use rally scoring.
- All sets are win-by-2 unless otherwise stated.
- Pool play matches are 2 sets played independently — no third set, no winner declared per matchup. Both sets count toward seeding.
- Best-of-3 bracket matches: first two sets to 21, third (deciding) set to 15. All win-by-2.
- Teams are responsible for being on their assigned court at scheduled match times. Teams not present within 10 minutes of scheduled start may be forced to forfeit.
- Bracket matchups and seeding will be announced by the tournament directors after pool play concludes. Teams should be ready to play the first round of playoffs by 1:00 PM.

USAV Grass Nationals Bids

- Division champions will earn bids to USAV Grass Nationals. Bid level matches division level — Competitive divisions earn Open bids, Semi-Competitive divisions earn B bids. Coed division will receive a bid to Revco nationals this year.

Division	Bid Earned
Men's/Women's Competitive 3s champion	Men's/Women's Open/AA Division Bid
Men's/Women's Semi-Comp 3s champion	Men's/Women's BB/B Division Bid
Coed Competitive 4s champion	Reverse Coed Open/AA Division Bid
Coed Semi-Competitive 4s champion	Reverse Coed BB/B Division Bid

After Your Tournament Run

All teams are welcome to stick around and play pickup with other teams that have finished. Just stay off any courts officially in use for tournament play. All we ask is you wrap up before the championships are over.

Day 1 - We ask that after you conclude pickup, help us lay the nets on the ground to lay overnight - please let us know if you need help on how to do so. Day 2 - If you have the means to help take down a net - please find a staff member in an orange shirt and let us know you would like to help. Thank you!

Day Schedule

Time	Activity
8:45 AM	Pool play begins
12:15–1:00 PM	Pool play wraps; bracket seeding announced
1:00 PM	Bracket play begins (possibly 12:15 PM Day 2)
~6:15 PM	Tournament concludes